Introduction

Teamfight Tactics (TFT) is a game where small balance changes can quickly reshape the meta by changing which team compositions are strongest and most commonly played. Patch 16.2 was especially important because Riot stated that the patch was focused on balance adjustments, including reducing the gap between AD and AP compositions, while also directly targeting several dominant units and strategies. In particular, the patch notes described T-Hex as a unit that had "certainly taken over the meta" and applied several large nerfs to its mana regeneration, shield, damage, and damage falloff. The notes also identified Yunara as the most dominant 4-cost unit and applied direct nerfs to reduce her power. In addition, the Hexgate Travel augment was removed because it made it too easy to access T-Hex and strengthen it further.

This project analyzes how the TFT meta changed from Patch 16.1c to Patch 16.2 by comparing top team compositions using pick rate, average placement, top 4 rate, and win rate. The purpose of the analysis is to examine whether the nerfs in 16.2 reduced the dominance of previously strong compositions and made the meta less concentrated. By comparing composition data across the two patches, this report aims to show how balance updates can influence player choices and the overall diversity of the meta.

Data and Method

This project compares the TFT meta between Patch 16.1c and Patch 16.2. The main goal is to examine whether Patch 16.2 reduced the dominance of previously strong compositions and made the meta less concentrated. This focus is supported by the patch notes, which explain that 16.2 aimed to lower the gap between AD and AP comps and included several important balance changes. The patch notes also state that T-Hex had taken over the meta, that Yunara was the most dominant 4-cost unit, and that Hexgate Travel was removed because it made T-Hex too easy to access and strengthen.

The data for this analysis was collected manually from top composition statistics for the two patches. For each composition, the following variables were recorded: patch, composition name, pick rate, average placement, top 4 rate, and win rate. The data was then entered into a CSV file and analyzed in Python using pandas and matplotlib. The comparison focused on both overall patch trends and shared compositions that appeared in both patches.

To analyze the changes, the compositions were first separated by patch. Then, the top compositions by pick rate were visualized for Patch 16.1c and Patch 16.2. After that, shared compositions across the two patches were compared using differences in pick rate and average placement. In addition, a simple concentration measure was used by summing the pick rates of the top three and top five compositions in each patch. This helped show whether the meta was concentrated around a small number of dominant compositions or spread across a wider range of viable options. The results showed that the top 3 concentration decreased from 2.93 in Patch 16.1c to 1.93 in Patch 16.2, and the top 5 concentration decreased from 3.94 to 2.79. This suggests that the meta became less concentrated after the patch.

There are some limitations in this method. Because the data was collected manually, some composition names had to be standardized before comparison. For example, slightly different labels such as "Void Baron" and "Void Baron Nashor" needed to be treated consistently. Also, if a composition disappeared from the top list after the patch, this does not necessarily mean that it completely disappeared from the meta. It only means that it was no longer present among the tracked top compositions in the collected dataset. Even with these limits, the method is still useful for identifying clear shifts in popularity and performance between the two patches.

Results

The results show that Patch 16.2 reduced the dominance of several leading compositions and made the meta less concentrated overall. In Patch 16.1c, the top pick-rate chart was led by **Ionia Yunara**, followed by **Piltover T-Hex** and **Noxus Kindred**. In contrast, the top chart for Patch 16.2 was led by **Ionia Ziggs & Ryze**, **Bilgewater Value**, and **Ionia Yunara**, while **Piltover T-Hex** no longer appeared among the top tracked compositions. This suggests that the patch significantly weakened some of the most dominant strategies from 16.1c.

This pattern is also supported by the concentration analysis. The total pick rate of the top three compositions dropped from **2.93** in Patch 16.1c to **1.93** in Patch 16.2. Similarly, the top five concentration dropped from **3.94** to **2.79**. These results indicate that the meta in Patch 16.1c was more concentrated around a small number of highly popular compositions, while Patch 16.2 showed a more spread-out distribution of viable choices.

The shared composition comparison provides a clearer view of which strategies rose or fell after the patch. Among the compositions that appeared in both patches, **Ionia Yunara** showed the largest drop in pick rate, decreasing by **0.65**. Other shared compositions such as **Vayne Demacia** and **Void Baron Nashor** also declined slightly. On the other hand, **Yordle Veigar**, **Bilgewater Value**, and **Shadow Isles** increased in pick rate after the patch. This suggests that Patch 16.2 shifted player preference away from the most dominant pre-patch options and opened more room for alternative lines.

These findings are consistent with the 16.2 patch notes. Riot stated that Patch 16.2 aimed to reduce the difference between AD and AP compositions and described T-Hex as a unit that had "certainly taken over the meta." The patch then applied large nerfs to T-Hex, including reduced mana regeneration, shield, and damage, as well as increased damage falloff. The patch notes also directly nerfed Yunara, describing her as the most dominant 4-cost unit, and removed the **Hexgate Travel** augment because it made T-Hex too easy to access and strengthen. Therefore, the decline of Piltover T-Hex and the reduced popularity of Yunara in the data are strongly aligned with Riot's intended balance changes.

Discussion

The results suggest that Patch 16.2 was effective in weakening some of the most dominant strategies from Patch 16.1c. The clearest example is **Piltover T-Hex**. In the 16.1c data, Piltover T-Hex appeared as one of the top compositions by pick rate, but it no longer appeared in the tracked top composition list in 16.2. This change is consistent with the patch notes, which describe T-Hex as a dominant unit and apply several direct nerfs to its mana regeneration, shield, damage, and falloff. The patch also removed **Hexgate Travel**, which had made T-Hex easier to access and strengthen. These changes likely reduced both the power and accessibility of the composition.

Another important finding is that the meta became less concentrated after the patch. The top 3 concentration fell from **2.93** to **1.93**, and the top 5 concentration fell from **3.94** to **2.79**. This suggests that Patch 16.1c was more heavily centered around a small number of leading compositions, while Patch 16.2 allowed player choices to spread across a wider range of options. This supports the idea that the patch reduced the dominance of a few overly strong compositions rather than simply replacing one dominant comp with another.

The shared composition comparison also shows that Riot's balance goals were reflected in player behavior. **Ionia Yunara** had the largest decrease in pick rate among the shared compositions, which matches the patch notes that described Yunara as the most dominant 4-cost unit and applied direct nerfs to her damage and effectiveness against backline targets. At the same time, some other compositions such as **Yordle Veigar**, **Bilgewater Value**, and **Shadow Isles** became more popular. This suggests that after the strongest pre-patch options were weakened, players were more willing to use alternative lines.

However, this analysis also has some limits. The dataset was collected manually from top composition statistics, so naming differences between compositions had to be standardized during comparison. Also, a composition disappearing from the top list does not prove that it completely disappeared from the wider meta. It only shows that it was no longer among the top tracked compositions in this dataset. Because of this, the findings should be interpreted as evidence of a strong shift in top-level composition popularity rather than a complete description of all playable strategies in the patch.

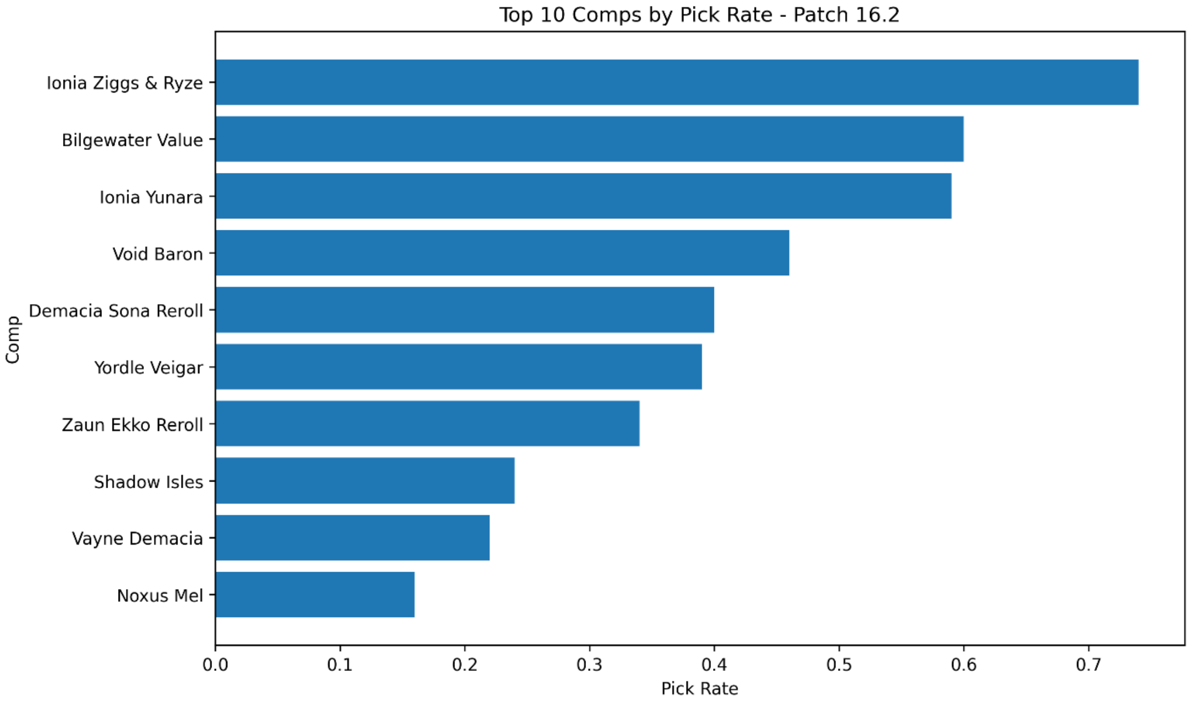
Conclusion

This project examined how the TFT meta changed from Patch 16.1c to Patch 16.2 by comparing top team compositions using pick rate, average placement, top 4 rate, and win rate. The results show that Patch 16.2 reduced the dominance of some of the strongest pre-patch strategies and made the meta less concentrated overall. The clearest example was **Piltover T-Hex**, which appeared as a leading composition in 16.1c but no longer appeared in the tracked top composition list in 16.2. At the same time, the concentration of the top three and top five compositions fell noticeably, suggesting that the patch created a wider spread of viable options.

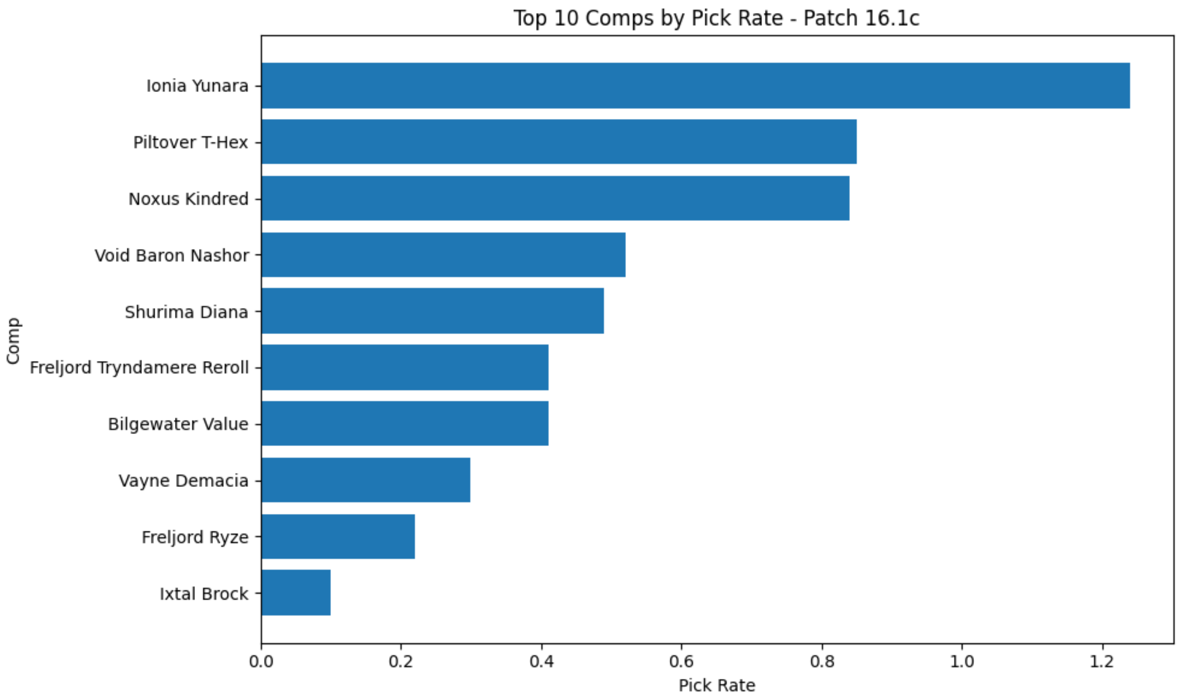
These findings are consistent with Riot's balance goals in the 16.2 patch notes. Riot directly described T-Hex as a dominant unit and applied several large nerfs, while Yunara was also identified as an overly strong 4-cost and was nerfed as well. The patch also removed **Hexgate Travel**, which further reduced access to one of the most dominant strategies. Together, these changes help explain why compositions such as **Piltover T-Hex** and **Ionia Yunara** became less dominant after the patch.

Overall, the analysis suggests that Patch 16.2 was effective in weakening a small number of overpowered strategies and making the meta healthier and more diverse. Although this project used a limited manually collected dataset, it still clearly shows how balance patches can affect player choices and reshape the competitive meta in TFT.

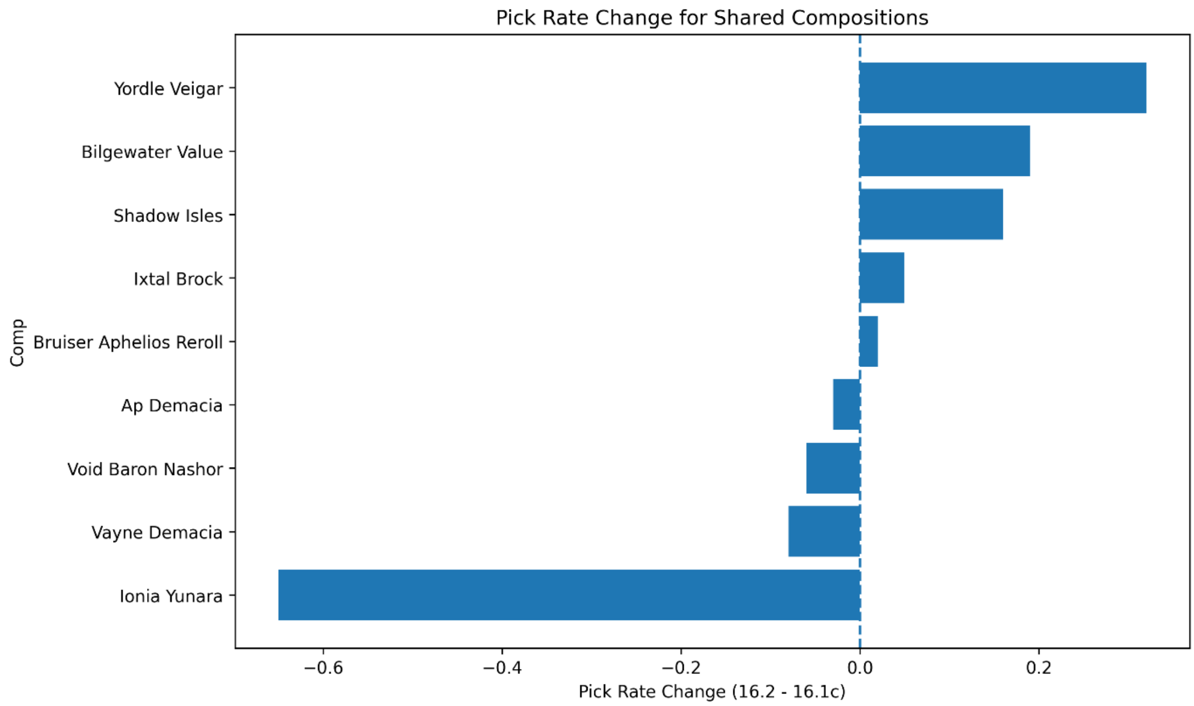
Appendix



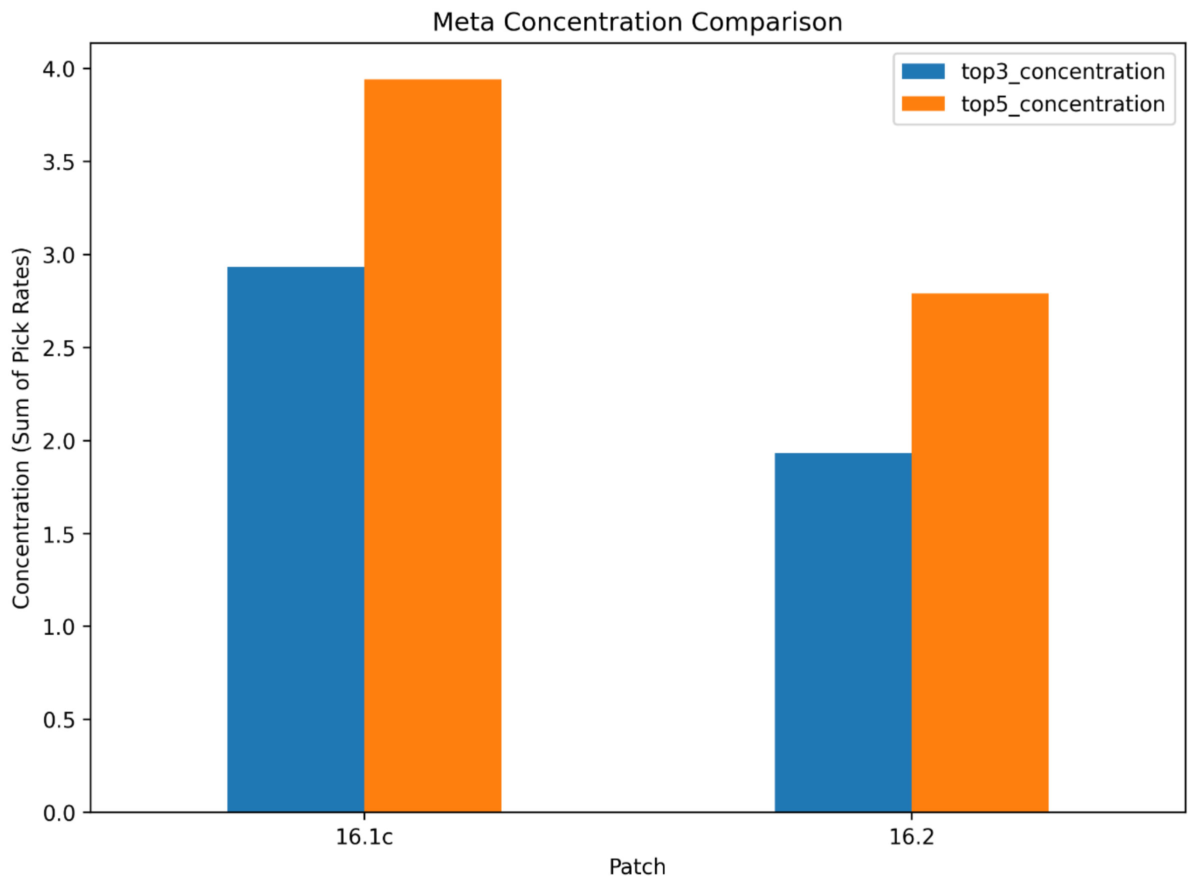
Top 10 Comps by Pick Rate - Patch 16.2
Ionia Ziggs & Ryze
Bilgewater Value
Ionia Yunara
Void Baron
Demacia Sona Reroll
Yordle Veigar
Zaun Ekko Reroll
Shadow Isles
Vayne Demacia
Noxus Mel
Comp
0.0
0.1
0.2
0.3
0.4
0.5
0.6
0.7
Pick Rate



Top 10 Comps by Pick Rate - Patch 16.1c
Ionia Yunara
Piltover T-Hex
Noxus Kindred
Void Baron Nashor
Shurima Diana
Freljord Tryndamere Reroll
Bilgewater Value
Vayne Demacia
Freljord Ryze
Ixtal Brock
Comp
0.0
0.2
0.4
0.6
0.8
1.0
1.2
Pick Rate



Pick Rate Change for Shared Compositions
Yordle Veigar
Bilgewater Value
Shadow Isles
Ixtal Brock
Bruiser Aphelios Reroll
Ap Demacia
Void Baron Nashor
Vayne Demacia
Ionia Yunara
Comp
−0.6
−0.4
−0.2
0.0
0.2
Pick Rate Change (16.2 - 16.1c)



Meta Concentration Comparison
top3_concentration
top5_concentration
Concentration (Sum of Pick Rates)
0.0
0.5
1.0
1.5
2.0
2.5
3.0
3.5
4.0
16.1c
16.2
Patch

References

Riot Games. (2026). Teamfight Tactics Patch 16.2 Notes.

tactics.tools. (2026). Team Compositions statistics for Teamfight Tactics, Patch 16.1c and Patch 16.2.

tactics.tools. (2026). Trends and meta statistics for Teamfight Tactics.